

Professional Skills I: Presenting Guidelines for Final Speech

Deadlines

1. Complete draft speech and phrasing by Wednesday at 9AM. Time it to be less than 3 minutes when read aloud. Practice!
2. During lunch on Wednesday, find Andrii or Laker for feedback on your text and phrasing. You can show us your text on your phone.
3. Complete final draft of speech and text by Thursday at 9AM.

We want to give you the best opportunity to practice presentation skills as we can. On Friday, when you give your final speech, we will be running on a tight schedule. That's why we are implementing guidelines for the speech. Even though it would be great to give everybody slides and ten minutes to talk, we want you to focus on presentation skills. That means learning your text by heart and relying on meaningful gestures, vocal variation, and all our other techniques to show your audience what you mean.

Guidelines

1. The time limit for your speech is 3 minutes.
2. Time yourself. Read your speech aloud to make sure it takes you less than 3 minutes.
3. If you have a very good reason why you need more time, ask Andrii or Laker.
4. In order to best practice presentation skills, you must stick to your speech word for word. Do not improvise. For the same reason, you will speak without slides.
5. You are welcome to edit your speech until Wednesday night. That's the deadline for the text.

Here are some ideas for how to fit your speech into 3 minutes.

Tips for Shortening

1. Don't introduce yourself: no "Hello, I'm [...] and today I'll be talking about ..."
2. Focus on the why, not the what. Only spend two sentences describing the technical details of your project. For the rest, tell a story for why we should care.
3. Do not ask for audience interaction. Rhetorical questions (where you don't expect the audience to answer anything) are fine.
4. If you're struggling to remove sentences, write three bullet points with your three most important ideas. Pick the sentences that support these bullet points for your speech.